

Helion Energy

Fusion Energy / Clean Power · Everett, WA · Private (~\$15.5B; pre-revenue; \$465M Series G, Jun 2026)

Sam Altman-backed fusion pioneer Helion just raised \$465M at a \$15.5B valuation - nearly 3x in 18 months - with the world's first fusion power deal (Microsoft, 2028) and no motorsport footprint: the definitive clean-energy brand for Formula E's clean-mobility stage.

73

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Envision Racing

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Helion Energy is the fusion company turning 'limitless clean power' from physics into a construction site. In June 2026 it raised a \$465M Series G at a \$15.5B valuation - nearly tripling from \$5.43B in January 2025 - to build Orion, its first commercial plant (Malaga, WA), which will deliver 50MW to Microsoft by 2028 under the world's first fusion power-purchase agreement. In February 2026 its Polaris machine became the first privately-funded device to run on deuterium-tritium fuel and reach 150 million degrees. For 1440 the fit is narrative, not operational: fusion is the definitive clean-energy story and Formula E is the championship built to prove clean mobility, so a Helion-FE pairing is the most on-message sustainability partnership on any grid - and Helion has never touched motorsport. The honest counterweight: it is pre-revenue and pouring capital into reactors, so its near-term sponsorship appetite is the open question - a brand/relationship play to open now, not a deal to force.

WHY NOW

Helion just closed a \$465M round at a \$15.5B valuation - a peak-visibility moment - and is moving publicly from lab milestone (Polaris) to construction (Orion for Microsoft, 2028). That arc is exactly when a deep-tech brand benefits from a global, on-narrative stage and a STEM-talent magnet. No clean-energy or fusion brand holds an FE position, so the on-theme lane is open and cheap to plant now.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$15.5B

Valuation (Series G, Jun 2026; ~3x from \$5.43B in Jan 2025)

\$465M

Series G raise

Microsoft PPA

World's first fusion power deal: Orion plant -> 50MW to Microsoft by 2028

150M degrees C

Polaris: first privately-funded D-T fusion machine, 150M degrees (Feb 2026)

David Kirtley

Founder & CEO

Altman off board

Chairman/investor Sam Altman left the board (Mar 2026, OpenAI-conflict recusal)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Envision Racing	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Nissan	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

Fusion is the definitive clean-energy story and Formula E is the championship built to prove clean mobility - the most on-message sustainability pairing on any grid. Helion just raised \$465M at \$15.5B with the world's first fusion power deal (Microsoft, 2028) and no motorsport footprint. The honest caveat: pre-revenue deep-tech, so this is a brand/relationship play, not a deal to force.

FUNDING EVENT

NEVER ENTERED

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SEED

WHY ENVISION RACING

Envision Racing is the sharpest fit: a sustainability-first independent whose entire identity ('Race Against Climate Change') mirrors Helion's clean-energy mission, with a clean (greenfield) roster so Helion can own the clean-energy lane outright. A manufacturer team (e.g. Nissan or Jaguar) is the alternative if a larger stage is preferred over thematic purity.

VALUE TO ENVISION RACING — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - a brand, narrative and talent partnership, not in-car tech (fusion doesn't power an FE car - batteries do). The substance is real on three fronts. (1) NARRATIVE: fusion is the definitive clean-energy story and Formula E is the championship built to prove clean mobility, so pairing 'the power source of the future' with 'the racing of the future' is the most on-message sustainability partnership available on any grid - and it supercharges Envision's own 'Race Against Climate Change' identity rather than bolting a logo onto it. (2) CREDIBILITY & COMMERCIAL: Helion's profile - the world's first fusion power-purchase agreement (Microsoft), a \$15.5B valuation, a Polaris machine at 150 million degrees - lends Envision a marquee deep-tech innovation halo that materially lifts a sustainability-first independent's partner roster and helps it win and keep other backers, while Helion's high-profile ecosystem opens enterprise and policy doors. (3) TALENT & CONTENT: a 'fusion meets electric racing' content platform and a STEM/engineering recruiting halo for both - Helion is hiring physicists and engineers at speed in a fierce market. Envision gains a category-defining clean-energy story, commercial lift and talent pull; Helion gains a global, on-narrative stage as it moves from lab to grid.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Clean Energy / Innovation Partner tier on Envision Racing, minimum three years, ~\$2-4M/yr (calibrated to a pre-revenue deep-tech's modest near-term appetite, structured to scale toward Orion's 2028 delivery), with category exclusivity for energy/fusion and a content-and-talent programme rather than heavy signage.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

David Kirtley

FOUNDER & CEO, HELION ENERGY - VERIFIED

David Kirtley co-founded Helion in 2013 (plasma physics / aerospace) and leads it as CEO & President; he owns strategy and partnership decisions. Co-decision-maker on a commercial deal: Chief Business Operations Officer Savanna Thompson. There is no CMO (deep-tech, no marketing chief), so brand decisions sit with the founder. Note: chairman/investor Sam Altman left the board in March 2026 (OpenAI-conflict recusal), so the thesis should rest on Helion's Microsoft power deal and the Polaris milestone, not on Altman.

OPENING ANGLE

"David, fusion is the clean-energy story and Formula E is where clean mobility proves itself - and no energy brand owns that stage yet. As you move from Polaris to powering Microsoft, a measured, on-narrative platform builds public credibility and pulls the physicists and engineers you're hiring. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Just closed a \$465M Series G at a \$15.5B valuation (~Jun 2026, ~3x from \$5.43B in Jan 2025) and is moving publicly from lab milestone (Polaris) to construction (Orion for Microsoft) - a peak-visibility moment.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$15.5B valuation, \$465M just raised, \$1B+ cumulative - funded; tempered only by being pre-revenue (no commercial fusion until ~2028).	BRAND FIT 17 / 20 Fusion clean energy on the clean-mobility grid is arguably the single most on-narrative pairing available; tempered by MODE B (a halo, not in-car tech).	URGENCY 12 / 20 A fresh mega-round creates a brand window, but there is no competitor-on-grid clock or dated motorsport anchor.	OPS FIT 10 / 20 MODE B: fusion does not power an FE car (batteries do), so the value is brand, narrative and talent - not an operational integration.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

SPONSORSHIP APPETITE (PRE-REVENUE DEEP-TECH) Helion is pre-commercial and capex-focused on building Orion; motorsport may read as off-strategy. **Counter:** Pitch a modest, relationship-first brand and STEM-talent platform - not heavy signage - timed to scale toward the 2028 Microsoft delivery; the on-narrative fit is rare and the lane is cheap to lock now.

MODE B / NO IN-CAR TECH Fusion doesn't power an FE car, so it is a brand halo, not an operational integration. **Counter:** Lean on the unmatched narrative (clean energy x clean mobility) and Envision's sustainability identity, with measurable brand and talent outcomes.

SOURCES

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